

Trigger Identification Worksheet

Trauma & PTSD — Understanding Your Triggers

Triggers are stimuli that remind you of a traumatic event and cause a strong emotional or physical reaction. Identifying your triggers is the first step toward managing them effectively. Complete this worksheet with your therapist or on your own.

Types of Triggers — Check all that apply to you:

Sensory Triggers:

- | | | |
|---|--|---|
| ☐ Certain sounds | ☐ Specific smells | ☐ Visual reminders |
| ☐ Physical touch | ☐ Tastes | |

Situational Triggers:

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ Specific locations | ☐ Time of day/year | ☐ Being alone |
| ☐ Crowds | ☐ Authority figures | |

Emotional Triggers:

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------------------------|
| ☐ Feeling helpless | ☐ Feeling trapped | ☐ Anger |
| ☐ Shame | ☐ Vulnerability | |

Interpersonal Triggers:

- | | | |
|-----------------------------------|--|------------------------------------|
| ☐ Conflict | ☐ Raised voices | ☐ Rejection |
| ☐ Intimacy | ☐ Being ignored | |

My Specific Triggers (list your personal triggers):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Trigger Response Plan

For each trigger, plan your coping response

Trigger #1

Trigger description:

How my body reacts (physical sensations):

Emotions I experience:

Unhelpful coping I want to avoid:

Healthy coping strategy I will use instead:

Grounding technique that works for me:

Trigger #2

Trigger description:

How my body reacts (physical sensations):

Emotions I experience:

Unhelpful coping I want to avoid:

Healthy coping strategy I will use instead:

Grounding technique that works for me:

Trigger #3

Trigger description:

How my body reacts (physical sensations):

Emotions I experience:

Unhelpful coping I want to avoid:

Healthy coping strategy I will use instead:

Grounding technique that works for me: